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Voters commonly condemn politicians for being insincere, but politicians often must disguise their true feelings when they make public statements. If they expressed their honest views—about, say, their party's policies—then achieving politically necessary compromises would be much more difficult. Clearly, the very insincerity that people decry shows that our government is functioning well.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines this reasoning?

A. Achieving political compromises is not all that is necessary for the proper functioning of a government.

B. Some political compromises are not in the best long-term interest of the government.

C. Voters often judge politicians by criteria other than the sincerity with which they express their views.

D. A political party's policies could turn out to be detrimental to the functioning of a government.

E. Some of the public statements made by politicians about their party's policies could in fact be sincere.

Argument Evaluation

Situation Politicians must often make insincere public statements because expressing their true feelings would make it harder for them to achieve politically necessary compromises.

Reasoning *What would suggest that the argument's premises do not establish that politicians' insincerity shows our government is functioning well?* The implicit reasoning is that insincerity helps politicians achieve politically necessary compromises, and these compromises help our government to function well, so insincerity must show that our government is functioning well. Evidence that these necessary compromises do not ensure that our government functions well would undermine the argument's reasoning, as would evidence that politicians' insincerity has other substantial effects that hinder the government's functioning.

A. **Correct.** If governments may function poorly even when insincerity allows necessary political compromises to be made, then the argument's premises do not establish that politicians' insincerity shows our government is functioning well.

B. The argument does not require that all political compromises help government to function well, only that politically necessary compromises do.

C. Even if voters often judge politicians by criteria other than their sincerity, they may also often decry politicians' insincerity, not realizing or caring that such insincerity helps the government function well.

D. Even if a political party's policies impair the government's functioning, politically necessary compromises by politicians in that party could improve the government's functioning.

E. Even if politicians sometimes speak sincerely about their party's policies, their general willingness to be insincere as needed to achieve politically necessary compromises could be a sign that the government is functioning well.

The correct answer is A.

•

One summer, floods covered low-lying garlic fields situated in a region with a large mosquito population. Since mosquitoes lay their eggs in standing water, flooded fields would normally attract mosquitoes, yet no mosquitoes were found in the fields. Diallyl sulfide, a major component of garlic, is known to repel several species of insects, including mosquitoes, so it is likely that diallyl sulfide from the garlic repelled the mosquitoes.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. Diallyl sulfide is also found in onions but at concentrations lower than in garlic.

B. The mosquito population of the region as a whole was significantly smaller during the year in which the flooding took place than it had been in previous years.

C. By the end of the summer, most of the garlic plants in the flooded fields had been killed by waterborne fungi.

D. Many insect species not repelled by diallyl sulfide were found in the flooded garlic fields throughout the summer.

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E. Mosquitoes are known to be susceptible to toxins in plants other than garlic, such as marigolds.

Argument Evaluation

Situation When summer floods covered garlic fields in an area with many mosquitoes, no mosquitoes were found in the fields, even though flooded fields would normally attract mosquitoes to lay their eggs in the water. Diallyl sulfide, which is found in garlic, repels mosquitoes and some other insect species and likely accounts for the lack of mosquitoes in the area.

Reasoning *Given the facts cited, what would provide additional evidence that diallyl sulfide from the garlic made mosquitoes avoid the flooded fields?* The argument would be strengthened by any independent evidence suggesting that diallyl sulfide pervaded the flooded fields or excluding other factors that might explain the absence of mosquitoes in the fields.

A. This could strengthen the argument if mosquitoes also avoid flooded onion fields, but we do not know whether they do.

B. This would weaken the argument by suggesting that the general mosquito population decline, rather than the diallyl sulfide, could explain the absence of mosquitoes in the fields.

C. It is not clear how this would affect the amount of diallyl sulfide in the flooded fields, so this does not provide evidence that the diallyl sulfide repelled the mosquitoes.

D. **Correct.** This provides evidence that there was no factor other than diallyl sulfide that reduced insect populations in the flooded garlic fields.

E. If anything, this would weaken the argument, since it is at least possible that some of these toxins were present in the flooded fields.

The correct answer is D.

•

The population of desert tortoises in Targland's Red Desert has declined, partly because they are captured for sale as pets and partly because people riding all-terrain vehicles have damaged their habitat. Targland plans to halt this population decline by blocking the current access routes into the desert and announcing new regulations to allow access only on foot. Targland's officials predict that these measures will be adequate, since it is difficult to collect the tortoises without a vehicle.

Which of the following would it be most important to establish in order to evaluate the officials' prediction?

A. Whether possessing the tortoises as pets remains legally permissible in Targland

B. Whether Targland is able to enforce the regulations with respect to all-terrain vehicle entry at points other than the current access routes

C. Whether the Red Desert tortoises are most active during the day or at night

D. Whether people who travel on foot in the Red Desert often encounter the tortoises

E. Whether the Targland authorities held public hearings before restricting entry by vehicle into the Red Desert

Argument Evaluation

Situation Desert tortoises in Targland's Red Desert have been captured for sale as pets. Furthermore, these tortoises' habitat has been damaged by people riding all-terrain vehicles. These factors have led to the decline of the tortoise population in the Red Desert, a decline Targland plans to halt by blocking current access and announcing new regulations limiting access to only by foot. Officials predict these will be adequate because prohibiting vehicles will make it harder to collect tortoises.

Reasoning *What would be most useful to know in order to evaluate the officials' prediction?* If Targland's new restrictions are not enforceable, then there is good reason to doubt the officials' prediction that these restrictions will be adequate to protect the tortoises. Thus, it would be useful to know whether either or both of the new restrictions can be enforced.

A. The prediction is not based on whether it is legally permissible to possess the tortoises as pets, but rather on

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A. The prediction is not based on whether it is legally permissible to possess the tortoises as pets, but rather on whether people will be as capable of collecting them.

B. **Correct.** The prediction is based on whether Targland can effectively restrict access to foot traffic. If it cannot, and people can still gain entry to the desert using all-terrain vehicles at points other than the current access routes, then the fact that they would still be able to gain access casts doubt on the officials' prediction.

C. The prediction in no way depends on whether the tortoises are most active during the day or at night.

D. The prediction is based on the difficulty of collecting tortoises without a vehicle—presumably because it would be harder to transport them. Therefore, it is not particularly relevant whether people on foot in the Red Desert often encounter tortoises.

E. The prediction would be just as likely to be accurate whether or not the Targland authorities held public hearings before restricting entry by vehicle to the desert. All that matters is whether the restrictions are effectively communicated and enforced.

The correct answer is B.

•

Yeasts capable of leavening bread are widespread, and in the many centuries during which the ancient Egyptians made only unleavened bread, such yeasts must frequently have been mixed into bread doughs accidentally. The Egyptians, however, did not discover leavened bread until about 3000 B.C. That discovery roughly coincided with the introduction of a wheat variety that was preferable to previous varieties because its edible kernel could be removed from the husk without first toasting the grain.

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest evidence that the two developments were causally related?

A. Even after the ancient Egyptians discovered leavened bread and the techniques for reliably producing it were well known, unleavened bread continued to be widely consumed.

B. Only when the Egyptians stopped the practice of toasting grain were their stone-lined grain-toasting pits available for baking bread.

C. Heating a wheat kernel destroys its gluten, a protein that must be present in order for yeast to leaven bread dough.

D. The new variety of wheat, which had a more delicate flavor because it was not toasted, was reserved for the consumption of high officials when it first began to be grown.

E. Because the husk of the new variety of wheat was more easily removed, flour made from it required less effort to produce.

Argument Construction

Situation Because they were widespread, yeasts capable of leavening bread most likely were occasionally accidentally mixed into the doughs of the unleavened bread made by ancient Egyptians. Despite this, Egyptians did not discover leavened bread until about 3000 B.C., around the time of the introduction of an improved variety of wheat that had kernels that could be removed from the husk without toasting.

Reasoning *What evidence would suggest these developments were causally linked?* If one of these two developments would not have been possible without the other, there is reason to think that the developments were causally linked in some way.

A. Continued consumption of unleavened bread tells us nothing about the improved variety of wheat and so provides no evidence regarding a causal link between that variety of wheat and the ancient Egyptians' discovery of leavened bread.

B. The availability of the pits for baking bread does not indicate that leavened bread could not have been discovered, and then baked, in the ovens that were used previously to bake unleavened bread.

C. **Correct.** Because gluten is destroyed when a wheat kernel is toasted and gluten is necessary for yeast to be able to leaven dough, leavened dough was directly enabled by the introduction of the improved wheat variety.

D. The new variety of wheat could have been reserved for high officials because of its delicate flavor even if the ancient Egyptians had never discovered leavened bread, so it does not imply a causal link.

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ancient Egyptians had never discovered leavened bread, so it does not imply a causal link.

E. There is no evidence to suggest that the discovery of leavened bread was in any way linked to flour becoming easier to produce.

The correct answer is C.

•

In parts of the Caribbean, the manatee, an endangered marine mammal, has long been hunted for food. Having noted the manatee hunters' expert knowledge of manatees' habits, local conservationists are encouraging the hunters to stop hunting and instead to take tourists on boat rides to see manatees. Many tourists are interested, so the plan has promise of achieving the twin goals of giving the former hunters a good income and helping ensure the manatees' survival.

Which of the following, if true, raises the most serious doubt about the plan's chance of success?

A. Some tourists who visit these parts of the Caribbean are uninterested in manatees and would not take a boat ride to see them.

B. Recovery of the species would enable some hunting to continue without putting the manatees' survival in jeopardy again.

C. In areas where manatees have traditionally been hunted for food, local people could easily replace the manatee meat in their diets with other foods obtained from the sea.

D. There would not be enough former manatee hunters to act as guides for all the tourists who want to see manatees.

E. To maintain a good income guiding tourists, manatee hunters would have to use far larger boats and make many more trips into the manatees' fragile habitat than they currently do.

Evaluation of a Plan

Situation	The hunters of manatees in the Caribbean are experts in the habits of the endangered animals. Because of this, conservationists are encouraging the hunters to stop hunting and to give tours to the many tourists who are interested in the animals, thereby helping to preserve manatees without forsaking their livelihoods.
Reasoning	*What would cast doubt on this plan being successful?* If there were additional evidence that switching to giving tours would be at least as harmful to the manatees' survival as hunting, then this evidence would cast doubt on the plan's likelihood of success.

A. The success of the plan would not depend on whether every Caribbean tourist has interest in taking a boat ride to see manatees; it merely requires that there be a large enough number of them.

B. This claim is relevant only if the plan is at least a partial success. It therefore provides no reason to believe the plan would not be successful.

C. If people who have traditionally consumed manatee meat as food could easily replace manatee meat in their diets, then that would suggest an additional reason why the plan might be successful rather than a failure.

D. This would provide some evidence that the plan might succeed, not fail, because it suggests that there would be plenty of work for the hunters, thereby helping to ensure that they had a good income.

E. **Correct.** If the hunters who switch from hunting to tourism would be required to have larger boats and increase their number of trips into the manatees' fragile habitat to maintain a good income, then at least one of the two goals of the plan would be less likely to be met: Either the hunters would not be able to have a good income or the manatees' habitat, and thereby the manatees themselves, would be at risk.

The correct answer is E.

•

That the application of new technology can increase the productivity of existing coal mines is demonstrated by the case of Tribnia's coal industry. Coal output per miner in Tribnia is double what it was five years ago even though no new mines have opened.

Which of the following can be properly concluded from the statement about coal output per miner in the passage?

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A. If the number of miners working in Tribnian coal mines has remained constant in the past five years, Tribnia's total coal production has doubled in that period of time.

B. Any individual Tribnian coal mine that achieved an increase in overall output in the past five years has also experienced an increase in output per miner.

C. If any new coal mines had opened in Tribnia in the past five years, then the increase in output per miner would have been even greater than it actually was.

D. If any individual Tribnian coal mine has not increased its output per miner in the past five years, then that mine's overall output has declined or remained constant.

E. In Tribnia, the cost of producing a given quantity of coal has declined over the past five years.

Argument Construction

Situation Tribnia's coal industry provides an example of the increased productivity enabled by new technology. In the past five years, coal output per miner has doubled. No new mines have opened in the same period.

Reasoning *What conclusion can be drawn from the information regarding average output per miner?* If coal output per miner has doubled in five years, then that increase would produce a corresponding change in overall output factored by the number of miners.

A. **Correct.** The passage states that output per miner has doubled in five years. If the total number of miners is the same, it would necessarily follow that overall output has doubled in five years.

B. While this is plausible, individual mines may have experienced the same or lower output per miner regardless of their overall output; they could have simply hired more miners to increase output.

C. There is no reason to conclude that new mines would have increased the output per miner.

D. It does not follow that a lack of increased output per miner implies a similar lack of overall increase; individual mines could have increased total output with more hiring.

E. While increased productivity might imply declining costs, such a decline does not necessarily follow—for example, savings in labor costs might be offset by the cost of the new technology.

The correct answer is A.

•

The quality of an unrefined olive oil is not actually defined in terms of acidity, yet extensive tests have shown that the less free oleic acid an unrefined olive oil contains per liter, the higher its quality. The proportion of free oleic acid that an olive oil contains is an accurate measure of the oil's acidity.

If the statements above are all true, which of the following conclusions is best supported by them?

A. When an olive oil is refined, the concentration of oleic acid in the oil is reduced.

B. The quality of an unrefined olive oil can be determined only by accurately measuring its acidity.

C. If an unrefined olive oil is intermediate in acidity between two other unrefined olive oils, it will also be intermediate between them in quality.

D. Free oleic acid is the only acid that unrefined olive oil contains.

E. People who judge the quality of unrefined olive oils actually judge those oils by their acidity, which the judges can taste.

Argument Construction

Situation While the quality of unrefined olive oil is not explicitly equated with its acidity, tests show that progressively lower levels of free oleic acid correlate with progressively higher quality. Levels of free oleic acid accurately correspond to the oil's overall acidity.

Reasoning *What follows from the stated relationships regarding acidity and quality?* The passage states there is a direct relation between levels of free oleic acid and overall acidity, but an inverse relation between

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levels of free oleic acid and quality: the lower the level of free oleic acid, the higher the quality. Taken together, these facts support the conclusion that overall acidity is a strong predictor of quality in unrefined olive oil: lower-acid oils will be higher quality, higher-acid oils will be lower quality, and medium-acidity oils will be of medium quality.

A. The passage suggests nothing about the effects of refinement on levels of oleic acid.

B. The facts included imply that acidity inversely predicts quality, not that acidity is the *only* way to assess quality.

C. **Correct.** The information supports the conclusion that higher-acid oils will be lower quality, lower-acid oils will be higher quality, and therefore that intermediate-acid oils will be of intermediate quality.

D. The passage states oleic acid levels precisely correspond with overall acid levels; it does not support the conclusion that oleic acid is the only acid in unrefined olive oil.

E. While the information certainly supports the conclusion that acidity affects the taste of olive oil, it does not follow that judges are evaluating olive oils specifically on their acidity, only that they are likely to prefer the taste of less acidic oils.

The correct answer is C.

•

Shipping clerk: The five specially ordered shipments sent out last week were sent out on Thursday. Last week, all of the shipments sent out on Friday consisted entirely of building supplies, and the shipping department then closed for the weekend. Four shipments were sent to Truax Construction last week, only three of which consisted of building supplies.

If the shipping clerk's statements are true, which of the following must also be true?

A. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction last week was specially ordered.

B. At least one of last week's specially ordered shipments did not consist of building supplies.

C. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction was not sent out on Thursday of last week.

D. At least one of the shipments sent out on Friday of last week was sent to Truax Construction.

E. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction last week was sent out before Friday.

Argument Construction

Situation A shipping clerk states five specially ordered shipments went out on Thursday. Moreover, all the Friday shipments exclusively contained building supplies; no shipments went out after Friday. Truax was sent four shipments, and only three of those shipments were building supplies.

Reasoning *What follows from the facts presented?* The clerk states Truax was sent four shipments, of which three were building supplies. Some or all of those three shipments could have been sent on Friday since *only* building supplies went out that day. That leaves at least one shipment to Truax unaccounted for. Since no shipments went out *after* Friday, it follows that at least one shipment to Truax must have been sent *before* Friday.

A. It does not follow that any of Truax's shipments were specially ordered; they could have been shipped before Thursday.

B. There is not enough information provided to conclude anything about the nature of Thursday's specially ordered shipments.

C. We can only conclude that *at least one* Truax shipment went out before Friday; if Truax's shipments were specially ordered, it is quite possible they all went out on Thursday.

D. All of the Truax shipments could have gone out on any day before Friday of that week, so we cannot conclude one shipment to Truax must have gone on Friday.

E. **Correct.** Since only building materials went out on Friday and three out of four of Truax's shipments contained building materials, it follows that at least one of Truax's shipments cannot have been sent on Friday and therefore must have been shipped on one of the days before.

The correct answer is E.

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The correct answer is E.

•

In Kravonia, the average salary for jobs requiring a college degree has always been higher than the average salary for jobs that do not require a degree. Current enrollments in Kravonia's colleges indicate that over the next four years, the percentage of the Kravonian workforce with college degrees will increase dramatically. Therefore, the average salary for all workers in Kravonia is likely to increase over the next four years.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Kravonians with more than one college degree earn more, on average, than do Kravonians with only one college degree.

B. The percentage of Kravonians who attend college in order to earn higher salaries is higher now than it was several years ago.

C. The higher average salary for jobs requiring a college degree is not due largely to a scarcity among the Kravonian workforce of people with a college degree.

D. The average salary in Kravonia for jobs that do not require a college degree will not increase over the next four years.

E. Few members of the Kravonian workforce earned their degrees in other countries.

Argument Construction

Situation In Kravonia, average salaries for college graduates are higher than for nongraduates. High enrollment in Kravonia's colleges will result in a far greater share of workers with college degrees in coming years. Overall average salaries will therefore increase.

Reasoning *What must be true for the conclusion to follow?* A growing percentage of higher-paid workers would indeed be expected to raise average salaries in Kravonia, but that average increase will follow only if college graduates *continue* to command high salaries even when their numbers increase dramatically. Therefore, the argument relies on the assumption that greater numbers of degreed workers will not increase competition for degree-dependent jobs and thereby lower their average salaries.

A. While this might be the case, the argument does not depend on relative salaries for workers with multiple degrees.

B. The conclusion does not rely on the motivations of Kravonians for attending college.

C. **Correct.** The argument relies on the assumption that college graduates have not received high salaries owing to the relative scarcity of degreed workers; if scarcity is the reason for those high salaries, an abundance of new college graduates entering the job market will lower their salaries and therefore lower the average Kravonian salaries overall.

D. The conclusion may rely on the assumption that salaries for nondegree jobs will not decline significantly since that would depress the average, but it does not rely on such salaries *not* rising.

E. The argument states that national enrollment figures indicate the percentage of all graduates will rise dramatically; there is no reason to believe the expectation of rising overall salaries depends on a low number of foreign degrees.

The correct answer is C.

•

Charcoal from a hearth site in Colorado, 2,000 miles south of Alaska, is known to be 11,200 years old. Siberia is located in northeast Russia, and Alaska is located in northwest America. Researchers reasoned since glaciers prevented human migration south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge between 18,000 and 11,000 years ago, humans must have come to the Americas more than 18,000 years ago.

Which of the following pieces of new evidence would cast doubt on the conclusion drawn above?

A. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was determined the charcoal from the Colorado site was at least 11,400 years old.

B. Another campsite was found in New Mexico with remains dated at 16,000 years old.

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B. Another campsite was found in New Mexico with remains dated at 10,000 years old.

C. A computer simulation of glacial activity showed it would already have been impossible for humans to travel south overland from Alaska 18,500 years ago.

D. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was proved that an ice-free corridor allowed passage south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge approximately 11,400 years ago.

E. Studies of various other hunting-gathering populations showed convincingly that once the glaciers allowed passage, humans could have migrated from Alaska to Colorado in about 20 years.

Argument Evaluation

Situation A hearth site in Colorado is 11,200 years old. Glaciers obstructed human migration from Siberia to Alaska, and therefore to the rest of North America, during a period lasting from 18,000 to 11,000 years ago, so researchers concluded human migration must have occurred before the glaciers blocked the land bridge—that is, before 18,000 years ago.

Reasoning *What would have made it possible for humans to migrate more recently?* The researchers' conclusion that humans must have come to North America prior to the obstruction caused by the glaciers 18,000 years ago is reasonable unless new evidence calls their premises into question. If, for example, evidence suggested the land bridge was open at any more recent date before the date of the hearth site, that would imply humans could have arrived later and therefore cast doubt on the researchers' conclusion.

A. If the hearth site is at least 11,400 years old, it would still fall in or prior to the interval when the land bridge was obstructed and therefore suggest humans must have arrived before the obstruction; therefore, that fact would not cast doubt on the conclusion.

B. A much earlier campsite would tend to support the researchers' conclusion, not cast doubt on it.

C. While this fact would imply an even earlier date of human migration, it would not cast doubt on the conclusion that such migration occurred *more than* 18,000 years ago.

D. **Correct**. Evidence of a corridor that allowed human migration 11,400 years ago—200 years before the date of the campsite—would cast doubt on the conclusion that humans necessarily must have arrived in North America much earlier.

E. The fact that hunter-gatherers could have made the journey to Colorado in twenty years has no bearing on whether they could have made that journey more recently than 18,000 years ago.

The correct answer is D.

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